

World Happiness Analysis for 2015 and 2022



Data Analyst I - Capstone Project
Entry Level

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World Happiness Report Background:

The World Happiness Report is a significant survey of the score of global happiness. The General Assembly of the United Nations invited national governments to “give more importance to happiness and well-being in determining how to achieve and measure social and economic development” (Helliwell et al, 2022, p. 3). These scores inform governments and organizations about the state of their countries' well-being for future policy-making outcomes. The first report was published on April 2, 2012. This year marks the tenth anniversary since governments around the world pledged to address the international interest in happiness by addressing six factors: GDP per Capita, Family, Life Expectancy, Freedom, Generosity, Trust, and Government Corruption, for a holistic approach to development (Helliwell et al, 2022, p. 3). In the 2015 report, 158 countries, and 146 countries in 2022 were ranked by their happiness scores. The following analysis aims to track the happiness scores of 158 countries from 2015 and 146 countries in 2022 to test whether scores have increased or decreased over these 8 years. This analysis also aims to test the hypothesis that countries and regions with a higher happiness score will score significantly higher in all six factors that contribute to the total happiness score.

Design:

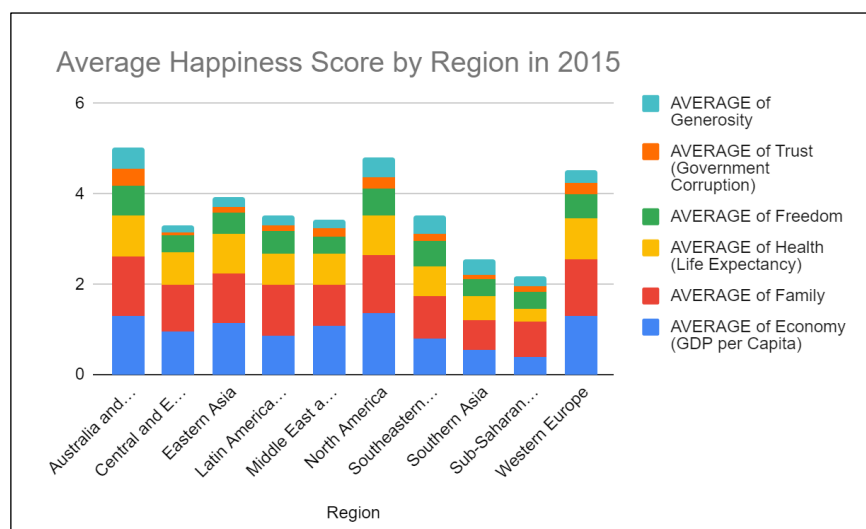
Cleaning the data:

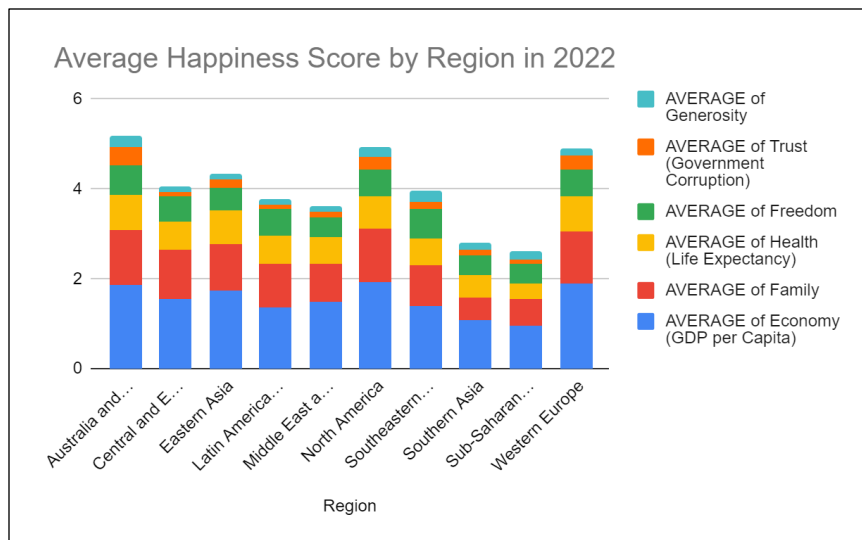
To clean the World Happiness dataset, headers for the 2022 data set were reformatted to be consistent with headers from the 2015 dataset. A region column was added to the 2022 dataset to be consistent with the 2015 dataset.

Visualizing the data:

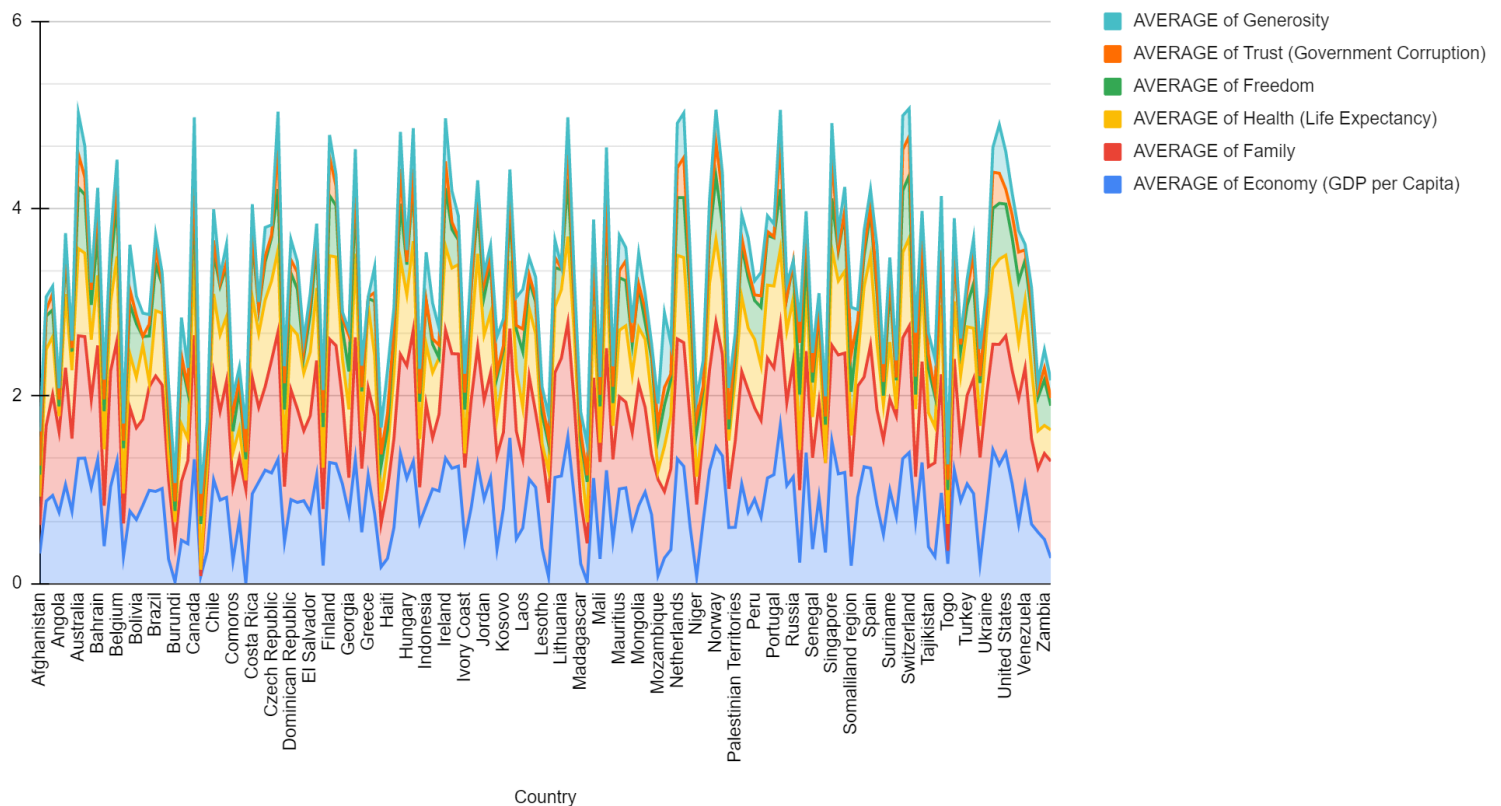
Google Sheets and Tableau were utilized to create pivot tables and charts to visualize the happiness scores across countries and regions in 2015 and 2022.

Findings:

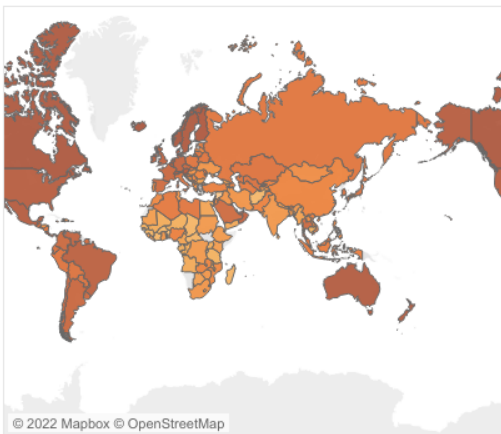




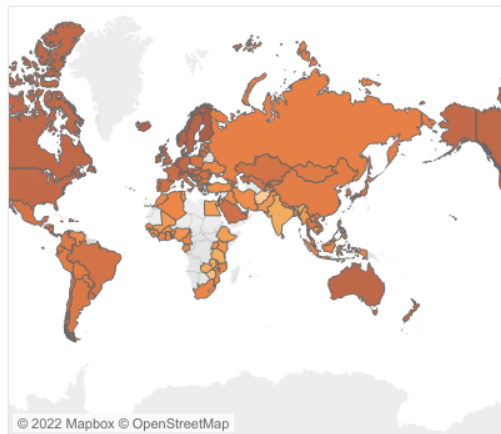
Average Happiness Score based on the average scores of Economy (GDP per Capita), Family, Health (Life Expectancy), Freedom, Trust (Government Corruption) and Generosity by Country in 2015



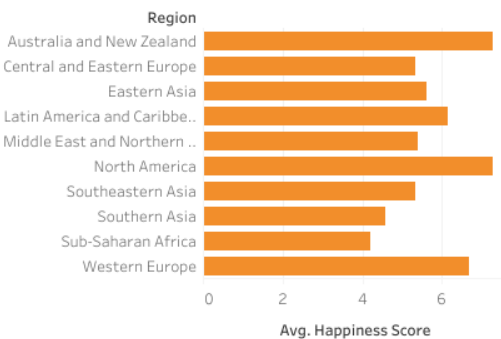
Happiness Score of Countries in 2015



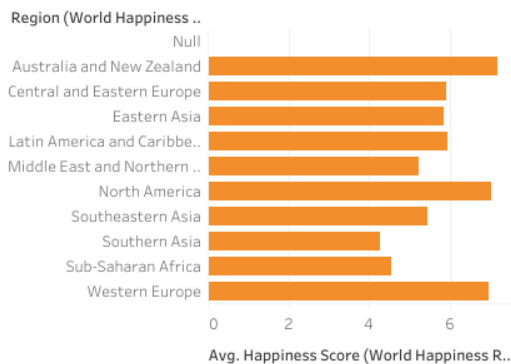
Happiness Score by Country in 2022



Average Happiness Score by Region in 2015



Average Happiness Score by Region in 2022



Analysis:

The findings of this analysis indicate that regions where democracy exists experience higher levels of happiness as opposed to regions where democracy is flawed or non-existent. Australia and New Zealand, North America, and Western Europe are all regions where populations rate their countries higher in all six factors that contribute to holistic happiness. Populations that scored their countries higher on GDP, region's GDP, explained as economy, social support, explained as family, life expectancy, explained as health, and freedom to make life choices all impart a significant role in the perception of overall happiness.

The root-cause analysis shows that global happiness scores have decreased from 2015 to 2022. All regions have experienced a declined score in all six factors that contribute to overall happiness. Despite scores declining over the past eight years, scores for the economy, family, and life expectancy have increased while trust in government, freedom, and generosity has greatly decreased. Happiness scores appear to depend on all six factors increasing and not just some factors increasing while others decline.

Conclusion:

Observations of the findings show that populations evaluate their happiness highly when all six factors attributed to overall happiness are met. Although global economies show an improvement, populations have seen a decline in confidence in areas of life expectancy, social support, trust in government, freedom, and generosity, which have all declined. According to an article in the World Economic Forum, democracy is declining (Willige, 2017). The article goes further to say that less than half the world lives in a democracy and areas such as the United States is now experiencing a flawed democracy due to low public confidence in the government (Willige, 2017).

Governments all over the world can benefit from the analysis of happiness reports to address their constituents' confidence in their governance. Creating campaigns to address life expectancy, and social programs that create and protect social support systems that can increase overall generosity within communities are ways to raise the trust in governance, which will raise overall happiness scores in all countries and regions. This report does not address the present socio-climate of the world that is currently navigating the turmoil of a global pandemic. Families and individuals feel the pressures of the uncertainty of this time as people turn to their government for direction and support with policies regarding health and social support. These external factors should be considered when thinking about the happiness scores of global populations.

In closing, Resolution 65/309 of the United Nations agenda seeks to address a holistic approach to global happiness. A happy population is a great indicator for world governments that they are meeting the needs of their constituents.

Citation:

Helliwell, J. F., Layard, R., Sachs, J. D., De Neve, J.-E., Aknin, L. B., & Wang, S. (Eds.). (2022). World Happiness Report 2022. New York: Sustainable Development Solutions Network.

Willige, A. (2017, February 23). Which are the world's strongest democracies? World Economic Forum. <https://www.weforum.org/agenda/2017/02/which-are-the-worlds-strongest-democracies/>.